

Chapter 103-5

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Liang Shi cooked noodles at noon, her whole person like a crab amid the rising steam.

However, Xu Qingzhu's call of "jiejie" kept making her lose focus.

She always felt like she had heard it somewhere before, but couldn't remember where.

In the end, she attributed it to the fact that perhaps because Xu Qingzhu had said it so seriously, when it reached her ears she had unconsciously added a romantic overtone to it, which was why she found it unforgettable.

Xu Qingzhu ate more than usual at noon. Liang Shi ate slowly and kept looking at her fingers while eating.

No one knew what she was thinking about.

She and Xu Qingzhu took turns washing up, and it wasn't until past two in the afternoon that they finally went out.

The immersive escape room they had booked was quite far away—it took over forty minutes to drive there, in another city center.

On the way there, Liang Shi drove while Xu Qingzhu sat in the passenger seat.

Somehow, the car's music first played the song Liang Shi had sung last night. Xu Qingzhu half-closed her eyes and hummed along softly to the melody.

After a while, the music in the car started playing "Elope to the Moon."

It made one unconsciously think of the scene from this morning.

Liang Shi's face turned a bit red again. Xu Qingzhu looked at her, noticing all her little movements and thoughts, but didn't call her out or say anything.

It wasn't until they arrived at the escape room shop that Xu Qingzhu leaned close to her when getting out of the car and said, "Teacher Liang."

Liang Shi: "Hm?"

Xu Qingzhu's voice was very soft, audible only to the two of them.

"Leave what happened at home at home." Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi: "?"

"Don't think east, think west, think south, think north, thinking this way and that~" Xu Qingzhu's pitch rose slightly, her tone melodious, almost enunciating word by word: "Over. Think. Ing."¹

Liang Shi: "....."

East, west, south, north—put together, it was very similar to the cheesy pickup line Liang Shi had used on her this morning.

Yet she had to say it in such a roundabout way, making Liang Shi's ears turn red.

Liang Shi said stubbornly, "I didn't say anything, and I wasn't thinking about anything."

Xu Qingzhu drew out a long "oh" sound, then continued walking forward.

Liang Shi: "....."

She felt like that sentence was really saying—forget what happened in bed, don't overthink it, I'm not taking it to heart.

At first, Liang Shi felt a bit uncomfortable in her heart, though she couldn't pinpoint exactly what was uncomfortable. She had been thinking about it, but when they entered the escape room shop, she put all those thoughts aside.

Xu Qingzhu picked a scenario with her and asked what she wanted to play.

Liang Shi looked at all the pictures hanging in the shop and finally chose the pink-themed escape room.

The theme of the room was—Fantasy Castle.

Xu Qingzhu smiled and said, "Are you scared?"

Liang Shi: ".....I'm scared that you'll be scared."

At this moment, Liang Shi had absolutely no idea that the experience of immersive escape rooms was—the pinker it looks, the more intense the gameplay.

1. This is a callback to the cheesy pickup line from Chapter 102. Liang Shi's joke involved the directions East (东), West (西), South (南), North (北) to spell out "baby" (北鼻). Here, Xu Qingzhu playfully uses the same directional framework: "东想" (think east), "西想" (think west), "南想" (think south), "北想" (think north), which together sounds like "胡思乱想" (húsī luànxiǎng), meaning "to overthink" or "to let one's imagination run wild." She's teasing Liang Shi for being distracted by thoughts of their intimate moments. ↩